

BETA-READING REPORT

Book: *The Missing Chapter*

Author: Daniel Mercer

Genre: Psychological Thriller / Mystery

Overall Impression

The manuscript has one of the strongest high-concept premises in the sample portfolio.

The idea of an editor discovering a manuscript that begins predicting her own life creates an excellent connection between protagonist, profession, and central mystery.

Strongest Elements

Suspense

The gradual progression from strange page count to increasingly personal predictions works extremely well.

Protagonist

Making Lena an editor is a smart choice because she understands manuscripts and therefore notices irregularities that another protagonist might ignore.

Chapter Ending

The final revelation that the voice outside the door is Lena's own voice is a strong cliffhanger.

Revision Suggestions

The manuscript should avoid revealing too much too quickly.

The mystery should expand through several questions:

- Who created the manuscript?
- Why does it know Lena?
- What happened to Chapter Twenty-Eight?
- Who is the author really working for?
- Is Lena changing the story or simply following it?

The middle section should also contain moments where Lena believes she has solved the mystery before discovering she was deliberately misled.

Recommendation

Highly recommended for further development.

The premise is strong enough to support a full thriller if the mystery continues escalating without becoming repetitive.

Beta-reader rating: 9/10